

A FREE GUIDE BY SERGIO VEGA

4 silent ways Spanish electricity companies overcharge expats.

A 10-minute audit guide based on real bills, from a Mapfre office director in Rojales who got tired of seeing the same patterns.

Why I made this guide.

I'm Sergio. I run the Mapfre office in Rojales, Costa Blanca. Two years ago I started looking at my father's electricity bill — Iberdrola customer, retired, living in a small place in Elche. I found a charge of €8.08 every month for something called "Protección 360" that he had never signed up for. €113 quietly gone in just over a year.

Then I checked my neighbour's bill. Same pattern. Then a few friends. Same pattern again.

After looking at dozens of bills from British, Dutch, and German expats living in Costa Blanca, I noticed the same 4 things kept coming up. Not always all four. Often two or three. But the pattern was consistent enough to be predictable.

This guide explains what those 4 patterns are, how to spot them on your own bill in about 10 minutes, and what to do about each one.

It is free. There is nothing to buy here. If, after reading it, you'd like me to take a look at your specific bill, you can reply to one of my emails with a photo. I'll tell you what I see, in plain English. If your bill is fine, I'll tell you that too. About half of my audits end like that.

— Sergio Vega

Mapfre Rojales office director · Asesor energético

The 4 patterns.

If your Spanish electricity bill is overcharging you, it's probably doing it in one (or more) of these four ways. After the next pages I show you each one in detail, with a real case.

01

Hidden line items

A monthly charge for a "Pack", "Protection" or "Smart Solar" service you don't remember signing up for. Sneaky 21% VAT (not 10%).

02

Inflated kWh price

Your energy price is 50-100% above the current market average — locked into a "Plan Estable" or similar fixed-rate trap.

03

Time-of-use tariff wasted

You have a 2.0TD tariff with peak/valley pricing, but you're being billed at one flat rate. You pay for the structure, you

04

Wrong power capacity

Either over-contracted (paying for power you never use) or under-contracted (your meter trips at peak demand).

A good user checks all four. Most overcharge cases involve at least two patterns running at the same time.

Hidden line items.

The single most common overcharge I find. And the easiest to fix.

Look at your bill. Find the section called "Servicios y otros conceptos" or "Other services and concepts".

If there is anything in there beyond "Alquiler del contador" (the meter rental — small, ~€1.60/month, normal) — you're likely paying for a service you didn't ask for.

The most common names I've seen on actual bills:

- "Protección Eléctrica Hogar" or "Pack Protección" (Iberdrola)
- "Pack Iberdrola" — sometimes hidden inside the bill detail
- "Smart Solar" — if you don't have solar panels installed
- "Mantenimiento del Hogar" — repair service you may never use
- "Hogar 24" or similar 24/7 emergency packs

HOW TO SPOT IT

1. Most hidden items charge VAT at 21% (not the reduced 10% for electricity).
2. They appear as a fixed monthly amount (€5-15), not linked to consumption.
3. The line item appears under "Servicios" or "Other concepts", not under energy.

Antonio's bill.

A retired man living alone in a small country house in Elche (Costa Blanca). Iberdrola customer for 11 years. He was paying €78.30/month — felt high for someone who barely used electricity, but assumed that was normal.

I never signed up for that. I would remember.

What we found when we opened the bill:

- A line called "Protección 360" — €8.08/month. With 21% VAT.
- On the bill for 14 months. Total quietly gone: €113.
- kWh price 0.159 €/kWh — about 40% above market.
- Plan Estable tariff — flat rate billing on a 2.0TD meter.

MONTHLY BEFORE

€78.30

Iberdrola Plan Estable

MONTHLY AFTER

€57.28

competitive switch

ANNUAL SAVING

€252

and Protección 360 cancelled

Antonio called Iberdrola, asked for the Protección line to be cancelled, switched to a fairer tariff, and stopped paying €252/year for nothing.

Inflated kWh price.

If your bill says "Plan Estable" or "Plan A Tu Medida" at the top, this concerns you.

Spanish electricity has two price systems:

1. Regulated tariff (PVPC): the price moves with the wholesale market. Currently around €0.11-0.15 / kWh.
2. Free market tariff: any price the supplier sets. Could be €0.10. Could be €0.22. Could be anywhere in between.

Many expats end up on "Plan Estable" or similar fixed-rate tariffs from Iberdrola, Endesa, Naturgy or Repsol. Sometimes signed up by phone, sometimes inherited from the previous tenant. They lock you in at €0.18 to €0.22 / kWh — comfortable for the supplier, expensive for you.

HOW TO SPOT IT

1. Find the line "Energía consumida" or "Energy consumed".
2. Look at the €/kWh price. If it's above €0.15, you're paying a premium.
3. If it's above €0.20, you're paying nearly double the market.

Ricardo's bill.

A retiree, Iberdrola customer with a "Plan Estable" contract. Low consumption — about 4.6 kWh per day. He thought his bill was small enough not to worry about. We checked anyway.

Three things we found on a 30-day bill:

- kWh price: €0.218 — almost double the current market (€0.11-0.15).
- A "Pack Iberdrola" line: €8.65/month with 21% VAT. €104/year gone.
- Power under-contracted: 3.45 kW contracted, 4.32 kW peak demand. Lights trip.

WE COMPARED HIS BILL AGAINST 25 ALTERNATIVE TARIFFS

All 25 were cheaper than his current Iberdrola plan.

Best option: an indexed tariff saving €22.80/month — a 36% reduction.

Worst alternative still saved €4.64/month. Every single one was better.

MONTHLY BEFORE

€62.81

Plan Estable

MONTHLY AFTER

€40.01

indexed tariff

ANNUAL SAVING

€274

and Pack Iberdrola cancelled

Time-of-use wasted.

You pay for a tariff structure. You never use it.

Since 2021, all Spanish residential meters use the 2.0TD tariff structure, which has three different prices per kWh depending on the hour:

- Peak (Punta) — 10:00-14:00 and 18:00-22:00 weekdays. Most expensive.
- Off-peak (Llano) — middle of the day. Medium price.
- Valley (Valle) — overnight, weekends and holidays. Cheapest.

If you don't shift any consumption to off-peak hours — washing machines, dishwashers, charging the electric car overnight, heating water at night — you're paying premium-hour prices the entire day.

Even worse: some "Plan Estable" tariffs charge you ONE flat rate as if the time-of-use structure didn't exist. You pay for the meter, you pay for the categories on the bill, but you get nothing back from them.

Compare to your neighbour on PVPC who runs the dishwasher at 2am: same meter, same usage, much smaller bill.

Wrong power capacity.

The mistake goes both ways: too much and too little are both expensive.

Spanish electricity bills charge you for two things: the energy you use (kWh) AND the power capacity reserved for you (kW).

Power capacity is a fixed monthly cost. You pay for it whether you use it or not. Too much = you pay for nothing. Too little = your meter trips every time you turn on the oven and the AC at the same time.

The 2.0TD tariff splits this into two power values: P1 (peak hours) and P2 (off-peak hours). Many bills set both at the same value — which often means at least one of them is wrong.

HOW TO CHECK

1. Find on your bill: "Potencia contratada" P1 and P2 (in kW).
2. Find: "Potencia máxima demandada" or "Maximum demand last 12 months".
3. If maximum demand is much LOWER than contracted: you're over-contracted.
4. If maximum demand is HIGHER than contracted: you're under-contracted (the meter usually trips at peak load, lights go off briefly).

The case we told NOT to switch.

A self-employed couple in Costa Blanca with rooftop solar panels installed. Iberdrola customer. They asked us to audit their bill — they had a feeling something was off.

What we did:

We compared their bill against 25 alternative tariffs from 5 different providers (NIBA, Gana Energia, Repsol, Endesa, Naturgy, Iberdrola). None of them would save them money.

Don't switch. Your current bill is fine.

But we did find something a comparison website never will:

- Their off-peak power (P2): 3.45 kW contracted.
- Actual maximum demand during off-peak hours: 0.00 kW (the solar covers everything).
- They were paying ~€60/year for off-peak power capacity they never use.

We told them: call Iberdrola, reduce off-peak power to the legal minimum (1.15 kW). No tariff change. No provider change. Saves around €50/year, no effort beyond a 10-minute phone call.

THE LESSON

About half of the audits I do end like this — no switch, but a small adjustment.

10-minute self-audit.

Get your most recent electricity bill in front of you. Work through these checks. If any one of them flags, your bill is probably overcharging you.

01 · Servicios y otros conceptos

Anything beyond the meter rental? Note the name. Note the amount. Note if VAT is 21% (not 10%).

02 · Energía consumida

Find the €/kWh. Above €0.15 = premium. Above €0.20 = nearly double market.

03 · Tarifa de acceso

Does it say 2.0TD? Are there 3 columns of prices (Punta / Llano / Valle)? If yes, are you actually shifting any usage to Valle?

04 · Potencia contratada

Find P1 and P2 in kW. Find "máxima demandada" in the last 12 months. Is one much higher or much lower than the other?

05 · Plan name

Top of the bill: "Plan Estable", "Plan A Tu Medida", "Plan Confort"? Those are fixed-rate flags.

06 · Provider compensation if solar

If you have solar panels: what € per kWh do they pay you for exports? Below €0.08 = below market.

Sergio Vega.

I'm Sergio. I run the Mapfre insurance office in Plaza España, 5, Rojales — a small town in Alicante, on the Costa Blanca. I've been working with British, Dutch and German expats here for years, mostly on home insurance.

The energy advisory side of what I do started accidentally. A few clients asked me "can you take a look at my electricity bill?" and the patterns I saw were so consistent that I decided to make it a free service.

I work in English and Spanish. The audit costs you nothing — there is no service fee, no commitment, no commission from you. If we switch you to another provider, the new provider pays me a small commission. If we don't switch you, you still get an honest report, and I move on. About half my audits end with "don't change anything".

If you'd like me to look at yours, just reply to the next email I send you with a photo of your last bill. I'll get back to you within 24 hours.

Contact

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Over the next 2 weeks.

You'll get 5 short emails from me over the next two weeks. One every 2-3 days. Each one goes deeper into one of the patterns above, with a real bill example and a clear action.

- Email 1** Pattern 01 deep dive: how to find and cancel hidden line items, with the exact wording to use when you call your provider.
- Email 2** Pattern 02 deep dive: how to read the kWh price, market benchmarks, and when switching is worth it.
- Email 3** Pattern 03 deep dive: time-of-use tariffs explained with examples — appliance by appliance.
- Email 4** Pattern 04 deep dive: power capacity, including how to ask for a reduction or increase.
- Email 5** If you want, send me a photo of your last bill. I'll audit it in under 24 hours, in plain English.

REMEMBER

You can unsubscribe at any time, and I never share your details with anyone.
No spam. No sharing. No pressure.

FREE AUDIT · NO COMMITMENT

When you're ready — send a photo.

Front page of your last electricity bill is enough. WhatsApp or email. I'll get back to you in plain English within 24 hours. About half my audits end with 'don't change anything' — and that's a real answer too.

WHATSAPP

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Photo of your bill. That's it.

EMAIL

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Attach a photo of your bill.

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All case studies in this guide are based on real bills, anonymised. Cases are individual — your results may differ. The audit is provided free as a service to help you understand your bill; there is no obligation to switch providers.